

Alex Manrique

SENIOR BACKEND ENGINEER · JAVA / SPRING BOOT / KAFKA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 13+ years building high-scale distributed systems using Java, Spring Boot, and event-driven architectures. Expert in designing microservices, Kafka-based streaming platforms, and cloud-native systems processing 100M+ requests/day with 99.9% uptime. Strong background in Finance and Payments domain with proven track record reducing operational overhead through automation and intelligent orchestration. Passionate about technical excellence, code quality, and sharing knowledge through open source contributions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend:** Java, Spring Boot, Kotlin, Python, Microservices, REST APIs, Event-driven architecture
- **Messaging & Streaming:** Kafka, Redis, RabbitMQ, Event sourcing patterns, CQRS
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL optimization, Schema design, JPA/Hibernate, ClickHouse
- **Cloud & DevOps:** GCP, AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD, Terraform, Monitoring (Grafana, Prometheus)
- **Practices:** TDD, Code review, System design, Agile, Technical mentoring, Cross-team collaboration

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer – Platform Team

Oct 2022 – Present

eDreams Odigeo

Barcelona, Spain

- Built Kafka-based event-driven microservices processing millions of real-time events/day with strict SLA requirements, achieving 99.9% uptime.
- Designed and implemented cloud-native backend systems on GCP with high availability, automated failover, and comprehensive monitoring.
- Automated refund workflow reducing customer support calls by 30% through intelligent orchestration and business rule validation.
- Scaled communication platform from 4 to 23 message types with open rates improving from 60% to 85% while maintaining delivery SLAs.
- Improved code coverage from 60% to 85% through TDD practices, comprehensive testing strategies, and knowledge sharing within 5-person team.

Senior Software Engineer – Convert Area

Oct 2019 – Oct 2022

eDreams Odigeo

Barcelona, Spain

- Maintained 99.9% uptime for Java/Spring Boot microservices handling 100M+ requests/day under peak load conditions.
- Built low-latency services (sub-100ms p99) for critical booking flows with comprehensive error handling and circuit breaker patterns.
- Drove migration of monolithic systems to cloud-native microservices on GCP, reducing infrastructure costs and improving scalability.
- Provided technical guidance to team of 4 backend engineers through design reviews, pair programming, and architectural discussions.

Senior Software Engineer – Marketing

Jan 2015 – Sep 2019

eDreams Odigeo

Barcelona, Spain

- Built real-time event streaming platform with Kafka enabling sub-second customer retargeting and increasing bookings by 30%.
- Designed REST APIs for Google Ads integration implementing dynamic bidding strategies that improved conversion rates by 20%.

Software Engineer – Finance & Payments

Jan 2012 – Dec 2014

eDreams Odigeo

Barcelona, Spain

- Built secure payment processing APIs and fraud detection systems, reducing fraud by 20% via 3D-Secure and real-time risk scoring.
- Designed high-throughput transactional systems with strict consistency and reliability requirements.

Prior: Software Engineer at Safelayer Secure Communications (2009-2012) - Secure authentication systems

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Open Source:** Spring Boot reference application with 89 forks, 36 stars – used globally as architectural example.
- **Technical Blog:** Active since 2017 (250+ subscribers) covering backend architecture, system design, and best practices.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science Engineering, Polytechnic University of Catalonia (UPC), Barcelona

2004 – 2009

Certifications: Oracle Certified Java SE 8 | Cambridge FCE (English)

Languages: Spanish & Catalan (native), English (fluent) | **Location:** Barcelona – Remote